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Unit 11 Fundamentals of Organic Chemistry



Friedrich Wöhler, was a German pioneer in organic chemistry. He is best known for his synthesis of urea an the organic compound from the inorganic compound, ammonium cyanate. This finding went against the mainstream theory of that time called *vitalism* which stated that organic matter possessed a special force or vital force inherent to all living things. He is also the first to isolate several chemical elements. He is the discoverer of the element aluminum and also the co-discoverer of yttrium, beryllium, and titanium.

Learning Objectives

After studying this unit students will be able to

- understand the reason for the tetra valency of carbon and shapes of organic molecules
- classify the organic compounds
- name the organic compounds according to IUPAC nomenclature and derive the structure from the IUPAC name
- describe various types of isomerism
- explain the principles of detection and estimation of elements in organic compounds
- describe various techniques used in the purification of organic compounds

Introduction

Organic chemistry is the study of compounds of carbon. Carbon has a tendency to form more compounds with itself and other atoms (H, O, N, S and halogens) than any other elements. The tendency of an atom to form a chain of bonds with the atoms of the same element is called catenation. The high strength of C-C bond is responsible for its catenation property.

The word 'organic' means 'derived from living organisms'. Organic compounds were thought to be found only in living things. Cell the basic unit of living things, consumes, creates and consists of mainly organic compounds. DNA, the genetic material, the